

LN905 Everyday English: Informal Food & Drink Vocabulary Exercises

Read the following paragraphs and use the context to understand the meaning of the highlighted words/phrases

Paragraph 1: The Office Party

Last Friday's office party was absolutely mental! Sarah had been **slaving over** a hot stove all afternoon, whipping up proper **tucker** for everyone. When we finally got **to dig in**, **the spread** was incredible – there was enough **grub** to feed an army. Of course, Dave immediately started to **pig out** on the sandwiches, **wolfing down** at least three before anyone else had **grabbed a bite**. Meanwhile, the management were living **high on the hog** with their fancy catering, sipping **bubbly** while the rest of us **knocked back** a few beers. By the time someone suggested we grab **a cuppa**, half the team were already **legless** from all the booze, and poor Jenny was completely **stuffed to the gills** after **polishing off** an entire tray of veggie samosas.

Paragraph 2: Weekend Cooking Adventures

Saturday morning found me rummaging through the fridge, trying to figure out what **to nosh on** for breakfast. I decided **to whip up** something special instead of just **munching on** cereal like usual. After a quick **swig** of orange juice to wake myself up, I started **chowing down** on the cooking process – dicing veggies, preparing a proper feast. My flatmate wandered into the kitchen just as I was about **to scoff** the last piece of bacon I was using for garnish. "Looks like you're really going to town on this meal," she laughed, taking **a sip** of her morning coffee. "Save some of that tucker for me!" By the time we sat down to eat, we both agreed it was the perfect way to start the weekend – no need to grab a bite somewhere else when you can create magic in your own kitchen.

Exercise 1: Slang and Colloquial Terms Matching

Instructions: Match each informal food/drink term with its formal equivalent or definition. Write the letter of the correct answer in the space provided.

1. Grub ____
2. Booze ____
3. Veggie ____
4. Cuppa ____
5. Nosh ____
6. Chow ____
7. Bubbly ____
8. Scoff ____
9. Tucker ____
10. Tipple ____

Options: A. Champagne or sparkling wine B. Alcoholic beverages C. Food (general term) D. A cup of tea E. Vegetable F. To eat quickly and greedily G. Food (Australian/New Zealand slang) H. An alcoholic drink I. A snack or light meal J. Food (informal)

Exercise 2: Contextual Usage and Phrasal Verbs

Instructions: Complete each sentence with the most appropriate informal food/drink expression from the box below. Some expressions may be used more than once.

Expression Bank:

- wolf down
- pig out
- grab a bite
- knock back
- chow down
- polish off
- munch on
- swig
- whip up
- dig in

1. I'm starving! Let's _____ somewhere before the movie starts.
 2. After the marathon, he managed to _____ three energy bars in under a minute.
 3. The kids love to _____ popcorn while watching cartoons.
 4. She can _____ a delicious meal from whatever's left in the fridge.
 5. Don't _____ your dinner so fast – you'll get indigestion!
 6. At the all-you-can-eat buffet, we really _____ on the desserts.
 7. He took a quick _____ from his water bottle during the break.
 8. The team celebrated by _____ a few beers at the local pub.
 9. Come on, everyone! The food's getting cold – _____!
 10. I can't believe you managed to _____ that entire pizza by yourself!
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Exercise 3: Advanced Idiomatic Expressions and Cultural References

Instructions: Read each scenario and choose the most appropriate informal expression that fits the context. Explain briefly why your choice is correct.

Scenarios:

1. **Situation:** Your friend has been cooking all day for a dinner party and is exhausted.

Options: A. "You've been slaving over a hot stove all day!" B. "You've been burning the midnight oil!"
C. "You've been pulling your weight!"

Your choice: _____ **Explanation:** _____

2. **Situation:** Someone offers you food, but you're already full from a large meal.

Options: A. "I'm stuffed to the gills!" B. "I'm under the weather!" C. "I'm over the moon!"

Your choice: _____ **Explanation:** _____

3. **Situation:** You're describing a restaurant that serves enormous portions.

Options: A. "They really cut corners with the portions." B. "The portions are absolutely massive – proper doorsteps!" C. "The food really hits the spot."

Your choice: _____ **Explanation:** _____

4. **Situation:** Your colleague always brings expensive lunches to work while you eat simple sandwiches.

Options: A. "She's really living high on the hog compared to the rest of us." B. "She's really spilling the beans about her wealth." C. "She's really cutting mustard with her choices."

Your choice: _____ **Explanation:** _____

5. **Situation:** You want to express that someone became very drunk at last night's party.

Options: A. "He was absolutely knackered by midnight." B. "He was completely legless by midnight."
C. "He was totally gutted by midnight."

Your choice: _____ **Explanation:** _____

Video

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fppLGXJMM0M>

Watch this short video and note down:

Food/drink that is good in Britain	What is wrong with British food culture

Discussion – what are the strengths and weaknesses of food culture in your country and do you have a favourite cuisine outside of your own?